Decision memo · 10 June 2026

Where our data warehouse runs

We recommend moving to a managed warehouse. Here is the reasoning and the ask.

Recommendation: move to a managed warehouse, and do it this quarter.

Our self-hosted warehouse is consuming an engineer full-time and still falling behind on query speed. We recommend migrating to a managed warehouse this quarter. It is faster, cheaper at our scale, and frees the team for product work. The rest of this memo is the evidence.

The problem: we are paying for a warehouse twice over.

We pay for the servers and we pay an engineer to keep them running. Queries that should take seconds take minutes during peak, and the on-call burden for the warehouse has grown to a day a week. This is infrastructure work we don't need to own.

- One senior engineer spends roughly 40% of their time on warehouse upkeep.
- Peak query latency has tripled over the past year as data grew.

The hidden cost

40%

of one senior engineer's time goes to keeping the self-hosted warehouse alive — about $90K a year in salary.

We evaluated three paths against four criteria.

We compared staying self-hosted, moving to Managed-A, and moving to Managed-B. The criteria were cost at our scale, query performance, operational burden, and migration risk. The comparison is on the next slide.

- Cost is modeled on our actual query volume, not list price.
- Migration risk weighs how much of our pipeline must change.

The three options, side by side.

CRITERION	SELF-HOSTED	MANAGED-A	MANAGED-B
Annual cost at our scale	$310K	$240K	$265K
Peak query speed	Slow	Fast	Fast
Ops burden	1 FTE	Near zero	Near zero
Migration effort	None	6 weeks	9 weeks
Lock-in risk	None	Moderate	Moderate

Managed-A · modeled outcome

What moving to Managed-A would change in the first year.

Modeled on twelve months of our actual query volume and current salaries.

−$70K
NET ANNUAL COST

4×
FASTER PEAK QUERIES

0.8 FTE
ENGINEER TIME RETURNED

6 wk
MIGRATION WINDOW

Where each option lands on cost and operational burden.

High cost · High burden.

Self-hosted today

High cost · Low burden.

Managed-B — strong, but pricier

Low cost · High burden.

A second self-hosted cluster

Low cost · Low burden.

Managed-A — our recommendation

Why Managed-A clears every criterion that matters.

01

Cheapest at our scale

$70K a year less than today, modeled on real query volume.

02

Fastest to migrate

Six weeks against Managed-B's nine, with less pipeline rework.

03

Lowest ongoing burden

Returns 80% of an engineer's time to product work.

04

Acceptable lock-in

Standard SQL and open export keep the exit door open.

Decision: migrate to Managed-A this quarter.

MIGRATE TO MANAGED-A

Saves $70K a year, returns an engineer, and ships in six weeks.

STAY SELF-HOSTED

No migration cost, but locks in the higher spend and the on-call burden.

CHOOSE MANAGED-B

Equally capable, but costs more and takes three weeks longer to migrate.

Data platform · data-eng@example.com

The ask: approve the Managed-A migration this quarter.